Session 8 — Student Activity Worksheet

Practice Session 5 — Hiware Bazar

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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, you should be able to:

- Identify the goal and the program followed by the village society of Hiware Bazar.
- Relate the village's work to the dimensions of education-sanskar, justice-suraksha, production-work and health-sanyam.
- Distinguish an integrated family / society from a fragmented one.
- Identify the indicators of a humane society (understanding, prosperity, fearlessness/trust, co-existence).

How to Engage with this Worksheet

- Whatever is stated here (and in the lecture) is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance, and validate it in your living.
- Treat each question as a dialogue: first between you and the material, and then within your own Self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- Hiware Bazar (Maharashtra) is a documentary about a progressive village where good governance and people together brought significant change — an oasis in drought-hit Maharashtra (rainfall 200–300 mm/year; no water tanker requested in 21 years, while nearby villages faced a water crisis).
- Education-sanskar: a compulsory school course on water management; students studying medicine; no liquor shops; no open defecation; no sweepers hired — all work done by residents.
- Justice-suraksha: 93 families returned; a participative, transparent gram sabha; about 10 lakh trees planted (90% success); no grazing in the forest (fodder grown instead); the second daughter's marriage expenses borne by the panchayat; a mosque built by the community for the only Muslim family; no cars within the village (cycles within, car pools outside).
- Production-work: water conservation (earthen and stone bunds, percolation tanks, check dams); tubewell only for drinking water, not agriculture; organic farming (moving toward 100% organic); increased irrigated area.

- Popatrao Pawar (Deputy Sarpanch): “I took 21 years to transform my village; now I have zipped the strategy to just 2 years — with community participation we can create a new era of rural change.” He was made a State minister and given charge of about 100 villages.
- Human society is based on relationship and co-existence; the family is the basic building block, and the family makes effort for participating in human society. A fragmented family/society has people living separately with conflicting goals, in arbitrariness (manmani), opposition and struggle, on assumptions such as ‘money is everything’ — leading to madness for consumption, profit and sensual pleasure, and resource depletion.
- In contrast, in some villages income rose but the misuse of money increased (liquor, gutka, gambling, expensive marriages, idle vehicles). Two questions arise: is physical facility available in sufficient quantity? Is there right utilisation of the available physical facility? Liquor and gutka are only symptoms; the all-encompassing solution (samadhan) is human conduct, human education and human order.
- Indicators of a humane society: Index of Understanding (% with right understanding), Index of Prosperity (% of prosperous families), Index of Fearlessness/Trust (% of people trusted unconditionally and continuously), and Index of Sustainability/Co-existence (enrichment of nature — air quality, water table, soil).

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Map the action to its dimension

Match each action of Hiware Bazar to its dimension: Education-sanskar, Justice-suraksha, Production-work, or Health-sanyam.

Action	Dimension
Compulsory water-management course in school	Education-sanskar
Planting ~10 lakh trees; growing fodder instead of grazing	Justice-suraksha / Production-work
Participative, transparent gram sabha	Justice-suraksha
Organic farming; tubewell only for drinking water	Production-work
No cars within the village; cycles within, car pools outside	Health-sanyam / Production-work
No sweepers hired — residents do the work	Education-sanskar / Health-sanyam

Activity 2 — Integrated vs Fragmented society

List the features of each, as shown in the deck, and then reflect on your own family.

- Integrated family/society — features: _____Mutual fulfillment, shared goals, transparent participation, living in relationship and co-existence._____ **features:** Arbitrariness (*manmani*), money-centric mindset, competition, opposition, resource depletion, and consumption-focused living.____

- Fragmented family/society — features (manmani, money is everything…): Mutual happiness and prosperity through right understanding._____
- Your family's goal: _____**:** Mutual happiness and prosperity through right understanding._____ | Your family's program: _____
- How does each member of your family participate?
- Engaging in clear communication, shared household duties, and responsible resource consumption.

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Answer in your own words, verifying each point on the basis of your natural acceptance.

Q1. What is the goal, and what is the program, followed by the village society of Hiware Bazar? **[5]**

The goal of Hiware Bazar is village self-reliance, mutual fulfillment, and environmental sustainability. Its program centers on community participation across education, water conservation, organic farming, and collective social responsibility.

Q2. Distinguish an integrated family / society from a fragmented one, as shown in the deck. **[5]**

An integrated society operates on trust, mutual fulfillment, collective responsibility, and harmony with nature. A fragmented society operates on individualistic desires (*manmani*), treating money as the primary goal, leading to social conflict and environmental damage.

Q3. The deck shows villages where income rose but the misuse of money increased. What two questions does it ask about physical facility, and what is the deeper point? **[5]**

The two questions are: (1) Is physical facility available in sufficient quantity? and (2) Is there right utilization of the available physical facility? The deeper point is that increased income without right understanding leads to resource misuse (e.g., addiction, wasteful display) rather than true well-being.

Q4. List the four indicators of a humane society given in the deck, and state what each measures. **[5]**

The four indicators are: (1) *Index of Understanding* (% with right understanding), (2) *Index of Prosperity* (% of prosperous families), (3) *Index of Fearlessness/Trust* (% living in mutual trust), and (4) *Index of Co-existence/Sustainability* (environmental health and natural enrichment).

Q5. Reflect on your own family's goal, program and the participation of each member, and compare with Hiware Bazar. **[5]**

Comparing family functioning with Hiware Bazar shows that while physical facilities are usually sufficient, establishing shared community goals and conscious resource utilization requires further alignment with principles of mutual fulfillment.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

- Does man influence society/system, or must man conform to it? Is there space in the current system for individuals to participate? (Slide 4)
- What is your family's goal and program, and how does each member participate? (Slide 4)

Prepared strictly from the lecture/practice-session slides (PS5). UHV-II, Module 2 — Harmony in the Human Being.